You only get 3 real shots

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📋 Executive Summary

Tim Luong argues that life offers only three genuine windows for high-risk, high-reward pursuits — and most people waste the first one. Energy, responsibilities, and risk appetite shrink with every passing year.

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🎯 The Three-Shots Framework 0:00

- The central claim: in your entire life, you realistically get **only three good shots** at pursuing major success
  - Most people squander their first opportunity without recognising its value
- Each "shot" is a multi-year window, not a single moment
- The clock is shaped by biology, responsibilities, and psychology — all of which shift against you as you age

⏳ Tim's Personal Timeline 0:00

- **Shot 1 — Ages 18–23 (≈ 5 years):** attended UC (University of California); launched three business ventures, all of which failed
- **Shot 2 — Ages 23/24–30 (≈ 5–6 years):** his first successful venture; consumed the better part of his twenties
- Framing these as distinct "experiences" or attempts reinforces the idea that each window is finite and exhausting

⚠️ Why Opportunities Shrink With Age 0:23

- **Reason 1 — Declining energy:** as you move past your peak youth, testosterone levels drop and raw drive diminishes, making it harder to pursue difficult, demanding goals
- **Reason 2 — Fewer responsibilities when young:** in your early twenties you have no spouse, no children, no mortgage
  - You can live with four roommates, eat noodles and ground beef, and grind on your passion every day of the week

    - Low overhead = high tolerance for low or zero income
- **Reason 3 — Risk appetite disappears with obligations:** once you have a family and a mortgage, the mental and emotional calculus changes completely
    - Taking big swings becomes "very exhausting" for your family, not just yourself
    - The psychological shift away from risk-taking is not a choice — it is a natural consequence of having dependants

> "You only have three really good opportunities in your life — make them count and don't waste your time."

- Takeaway: recognise which window you are currently in and treat it with urgency before energy, lifestyle, and obligations close it off permanently